

"WE DON'T WRITE HISTORY, WE MAKE HISTORY."



Courtesy Nehru Memorial Museum and Library

Vallabhbhai Patel

The big boss of Indian politics, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (seen on the left, with Lord Mountbatten) was the man of the moment the year after Independence. He has been called the "Iron Man," but Patel described himself as one of "Bapu's soldiers". He was responsible for bringing together 565 states and integrating them into the country. Patel was also credited with bringing "order out of the nightmare of chaos" as his powerhouse secretary V.P. Menon called the process. These included the troublesome states of Junagarh and Hyderabad. After much diplomatic negotiation, Hyderabad was brought under control in September during Operation Polo. Within four days, Hyderabad became a part of India.

Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

while talking to G.D. Birla

"We are having a grudging time, both with the weather and other problems; Kashmir, in particular, is giving us a headache."

Ms MELODY

Among Carnatic singer M.S. Subbulakshmi's admirers were Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru who called her the Queen of Song. As singer and actor, she took classical music everywhere in India, her career managed with great skill by her entrepreneur husband T. Sadashivam. She was the first musician to be conferred Bharat Ratna.



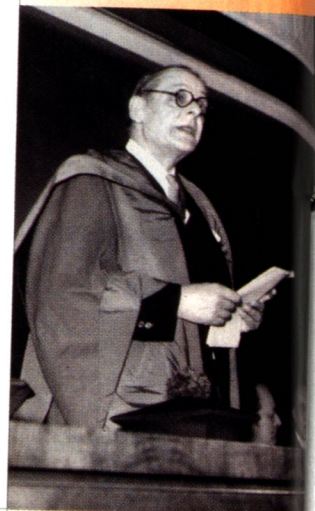
Courtesy Nehru Memorial Museum and Library



ELSEWHERE...

- The island nation of Ceylon—now Sri Lanka—became an independent dominion

AP PHOTO



- within the British Commonwealth.
- T.S. Eliot (above) won the Nobel Prize for literature.
- Mohammad Ali Jinnah died at 71.
- The World Health Organisation was founded by the UN.
- The new state of Israel was attacked by Transjordan, Egypt, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon.

11,500

acres, spread across 35 villages in Gujranwala and Sialkot districts, that refugee Vidyawati lost during the Partition. In compensation, she was allotted 835 acres in a village in Karnal.

The First Battalion of the Somerset Light Infantry passed through the Gateway of India in Bombay, the last of the British troops to leave India. Seen here is the first batch to leave in 1947. The battalion was presented a silver replica of the Gateway of India.